

Keep Costs Low

BEGINNER

PRACTICE WORKSHEET

Grab a pen and audit your own current investing costs. There's no wrong answer here — the goal is just to see, in black and white, what you're actually paying and where you might trim it.

■ Section 1 — Audit Your Current Costs

Which platform(s) do you currently use, or are you considering?

What's the expense ratio on your main fund or ETF holding (check the fund's factsheet)?

%

Does your platform charge a fee per trade, a spread, or a subscription? Which one(s)?

When did you last actually check your total fees for the past year?

■ Section 2 — Compare Your Options

Does your platform have a cheaper "pro" / "advanced" mode for the transaction you actually do (like Kraken vs. Kraken Pro)?

Is there an invite/referral code available from a friend, or one you could share?

If you're buying individual stocks, would a single low-cost ETF cover most of the same exposure for fewer transactions?

Tip: try the interactive "Fee Impact Calculator" on the Keep Costs Low lesson page at growthcapitalacademy.com to see exactly what a fee difference is worth to you over time.

■ Section 3 — Reflection

What's one fee you're paying today that you didn't fully notice until now?

What's one concrete change you could make this month to lower your investing costs? _____

How would you explain, in one sentence, why a 1% fee matters over 30 years?